

The Boston Globe

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IN THE MIDDLE OF THE ACTION



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Spring is sort of here, if you know where to look. The birds are back, the sun has some oomph at last, and Daylight Saving Time is coming Sunday. That's not to say winter is completely in the rear view, and if you want to play basketball outside, like a few kids outside the Mather Elementary School in Dorchester, you have to make some allowances. **As I See It, B1.**

As war intensifies, vets stress human cost

Concerns about an open-ended commitment

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

American military veterans are voicing strong reactions about the intensifying war in Iran: support for confronting a brutal regime, wariness about the long-term consequences, and questions about government transparency and trust.

In interviews, veterans from Vietnam to Iraq expressed anger about hundreds of past American casualties from Iranian-backed militias and mu-

nitions, while also calling for a public explanation of why US service members are being put in harm's way.

By Thursday, six American service members had been killed.

"There's no love lost with Iran in this, but on the other side, you're worried about a new forever war," said Jack Hammond, a retired Army brigadier general who served in Iraq and Afghanistan. "What worries us is going back to those two previous wars, where we didn't have very clearly de-

finied objectives or withdrawal criteria."

Hammond recounted Iran's role in the 1983 truck bombing of a Marine barracks in Beirut, where 220 Marines, 18 sailors, and three soldiers were killed. The Iranian regime also was responsible for introducing armor-piercing roadside bombs to Iraq, killing and wounding hundreds of US service members there.

"Just remember the history here," said Micah Jones, a Republican congressional candidate from Essex and

VETERANS, Page A4

Chaos in Beirut

An Israeli order for residents to evacuate immediately was followed by a bombing campaign that raised fears of a new front. **A4.**

Still in control

So far, major military operations have not threatened the Iranian regime's grip on power, officials said. **A5.**

Plymouth County Sheriff Joe McDonald moved to lay off 33 employees as he and other sheriffs navigate widespread scrutiny of their spending. **B1.**

A commercial fishing boat overturned off Provincetown and its two crew members are presumed dead. **B1.**

Jayson Tatum is expected to return to the court tonight, months after rupturing his Achilles tendon in May. **C1.**



The big sleet

Friday: Another fine mess. High 35-40. Low 32-37.

Saturday: Warming up. High 45-50. Low 41-46.

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Housing boom gives Lexington pause

Change happening too quickly for some

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

LEXINGTON — For centuries, one of the tallest points in this town's historic center has been Belfry Hill, where a replica of the old wooden tower whose bells rang out at the start of the battles that began the Revolutionary War has long stood.

Soon, the belfry may have a more modern neighbor, almost as tall: a four-story mixed-use development

that will include more than 50 new homes.

The new building still requires approvals from a few municipal boards, including the town's historic districts commission. But if all goes to plan, it would pave the way for a building that, to many, symbolizes the change suddenly sweeping through a community whose identity is tied to events of 250 years ago, and the preservation of it.

Lexington is set to add around 1,600 new apartments and condominiums in the coming years, turning this community of 35,000, which has built little in decades, into

the state's new housing boomtown.

All of those new homes are the result of the ambitious plan Lexington passed in 2023 under the state's MBTA Communities Act. Even as other towns mulled rebellion, affluent, liberal Lexington became the first place to pass new zoning rules under the law — allowing tall, dense buildings in key parts of town — and won plaudits from advocates, state officials, and even a glowing article in *The New Yorker*.

But the reality of so much growth so quickly is, well, complicated.

Once-enthused residents are

LEXINGTON, Page A7

RFK Jr. not exactly sweet on Dunkin'

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

AUSTIN, Texas — As Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. ticked through a list of ways the Trump administration is trying to clean up the nation's food supply before an appreciative Texas crowd last week, he previewed more to come, including potentially pulling certain ingredients from the market if they can't be proven safe.

And then he singled out a Massachusetts staple.

"We're going to ask Dunkin' Donuts and Starbucks, 'Show us the safety data that show that it's OK for a teenage girl to drink an iced coffee with 115 grams of sugar in it,'" Kennedy told the applauding audience. "I don't think they're gonna be able to do it."

It's unclear if the administration will follow through on such demands and restrict sugary beverages at Dunkin' and similar chains, despite Kennedy's declarative comments at the Austin food-focused

DUNKIN', Page A7



GLOBE STAFF ILLUSTRATION WITH IMAGES FROM DUNKIN' AND AP

Trump fires Noem after GOP grilling

Homeland security chief at center of controversies

By Michael C. Bender, Michael Gold, Hamed Aleaziz, and Maggie Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump fired his embattled homeland security secretary, Kristi Noem, on Thursday and announced plans to replace her with Senator Markwayne Mullin of Oklahoma, after she was grilled by Republican lawmakers this week at congressional hearings on a variety of topics, including her knowledge of a contract with a politically connected firm.

Trump announced the change on social media, along with a new, and previously non-existent, role for Noem: special envoy for the Shield of the Americas, which he said would be a new security initiative for the Western Hemisphere.

Trump is close with Mullin, a Republican, and speaks with him regularly. Mullin said that Noem had "done the best that she could do under the circumstances," but that he hoped to learn from her tenure and "build off things that didn't quite go as



Kristi Noem had a key role in the mass deportation effort.

NOEM, Page A6

Haitian living in Boston dies in ICE custody, family says

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio and Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

A Haitian man who had been living in Dorchester died in Immigration and Customs Enforcement custody this week after an untreated tooth infection led to sepsis, according to his family.

Emmanuel Damas, 56, had been held at the Florence Correctional Center in Arizona since around October, after his arrest in Boston on a domestic incident involving his son.

In mid-February, Damas told personnel at the Florence facility that he had a toothache, but he was not sent to a dentist, his brother Presly Nelson said in an interview.

Damas was seeking asylum and had entered the country legally through a Joe Biden-era humanitarian parole program for Haitians in 2024, Nelson said.

Damas died Monday at a Scottsdale hospital, af-

ICE, Page A6

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